

TOOL

Phrase bank

Exam-ready phrases for every text type. Build them into your own sentences.

ESSAY

Giving your opinion (without overusing "I")

- It is (firmly) believed that...
- One can argue that...
- Many people are convinced that...
- As far as many people are concerned,...
- It is often argued that...

When you do use "I"

- In my opinion/view,...
- I am inclined to believe that...
- I (firmly) believe that...
- I am (not) convinced that...

Adding arguments

- Furthermore,...
- Moreover,...
- In addition to this,...
- What is more,...
- Not only... but also...

Introducing the other side

- One should, nevertheless, consider...
- The other side of the coin is that...
- On the other hand,...
- Admittedly,...

Conclusions

- Taking these points into consideration,...
- All of this points to the conclusion that...
- On balance, we can safely say that...
- The arguments presented prove that...

ARTICLE

Openings

- Have you ever...?
- Do you remember the first time that...?
- Are you one of those people who...?
- There is nothing worse than...

Engaging throughout

- Can you imagine...?
- If you ask me,...
- You may not agree with me, but...
- I will never forget the time when...
- To be honest, it scares me when I think that...

Conclusions

- So next time you...
- The question is not whether... but when.
- Perhaps it's time we all...
- Food for thought, isn't it?

REPORT

Introduction

- As requested, I have prepared a report on...
- The aim of this report is to...
- This report examines/compares...
- The data was collected through...

Presenting data

- Twenty per cent of the people asked...
- The majority of respondents...
- One out of five stated that...
- It is generally felt that...
- A large proportion of those interviewed...

Conclusion / Recommendations

- On the basis of these findings,...
- I would therefore recommend/suggest that...
- It would seem that... is the best option.
- In view of this, one can recommend...
- It would also be advisable to...

BLOG

Blog post openers

- It took me ages to figure this out, but...
- So, here's what I've been thinking about...
- You won't believe what happened to me...
- OK so hear me out —

Blog comment openers

- Hi [name], I've just seen your blog on...
- I stumbled across your post and...
- This really resonated with me because...

Engaging the reader

- What do you think?
- I'd love to hear your thoughts on this.
- Let me know in the comments!

- Has anyone else experienced this?
- Am I the only one who...?

E-MAIL

Complaint openers

- I am writing to express my dissatisfaction with...
- I am writing to complain about...
- I would like to draw your attention to...
- I was appalled to find...

Application openers

- I am writing to apply for the position of... as advertised in...
- I am writing with reference to your advertisement...
- I believe I am suitable for the position as I...

Letter to the editor openers

- I am writing in response to the article on..., which appeared in... on [date].
- I have just read your article on... and I feel I must respond.
- You raised some issues which I feel strongly about.

Closings (all sub-types)

- I look forward to hearing from you at your earliest convenience.
- I look forward to receiving the information requested.
- I am available for an interview at your convenience.
- Thank you for your cooperation in correcting this matter.